P310/1
Literature in English
(Critiquing Literary Works)
Paper 1
July/August 2026
3hours

BUGANDA EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL MOCKS

Uganda Advanced Certificate of Education

Literature in English
(Critiquing Literary Works)

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3hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- This paper consists of **two** sections; **A** and **B**.
- Section **A** is compulsory.
- Section **B** has **four** scenario-based essay tasks.
- Answer only **two**, **one** on drama and the other from a novel or short story.
- Answer **three** questions in all.

SECTION A

Item 1

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.

I am happy to join with you today in what will go down in history as the greatest demonstration for freedom in the history of our nation. Five score years ago, a great American in those symbolic shadow we stand today, signed the Emancipation Proclamation. This momentous decree came as a great beacon light of hope to millions of Negro slaves who had been seared in the flames of withering injustice.
It came as a joyous daybreak to end the long night of their captivity. But one hundred years later, the Negro still is not free. One hundred years later, the life of the Negro is still sadly crippled by the manacles of segregation and the chains of discrimination. One hundred years later, the Negro lives on a lonely island of poverty in the midst of a vast ocean of material prosperity. One hundred years later, the Negro is still languishing in the corners of America society and finds himself an exile in his own land.

So we have come here today to dramatize a shameful condition. I say to you today, my friends, so even though we face the difficulties of today and tomorrow, I still have a dream. It is a dream deeply rooted in the American dream. I have a dream that one day this nation will rise up and live out the true meaning of its creed: "We hold these truths to be self-evident" that all men are created equal." I have a dream that one day on the red hills of Georgia the sons of former slaves and the sons of former slave owners will be able to sit down together at the table of brotherhood.

I have a dream that one day even the state of Mississippi, a state sweltering with the heat of injustice, sweltering with the heat of oppression, will be transformed into an oasis of freedom and justice. I have a dream that my four little children will one day live in a nation where they will not be judged by the colour of their skin but by the content of their character. I have a dream today.

I have a dream that one day, down in Alabama, with its vicious racists, with its governor having his lips dripping with the words of interposition and nullification; one day right there in Alabama, little black boys and black girls will be able to join hands with little white boys and white girls as sisters and brothers. I have a dream today.

I have a dream that one day every valley shall be exalted, every hill and mountain shall be made low, the rough places will be made plain, and the crooked places will be made straight and the glory of the Lord shall be revealed, and all fresh shall see it together. This is our hope.

This is the faith that I go back to the South with. With this faith we will be able to hew out of the mountain of despair a stone of hope. With this faith we will be able to transform the jangling discords of our nation into a beautiful symphony of brotherhood. With this faith we will be able to work together, to pray together, to struggle together, to go to jail together, to stand up for freedom together, knowing that we will be free one day.

Martin Luther King.

1. The significance of a title lies in its power to act as the first, crucial point of connection, capturing the essence, theme and mood of a piece of work. Suggest an appropriate title for the passage and justify your choice.

2. Tone and mood are crucial literary elements that define the emotional landscape of a text. Discuss the tone and mood in the passage.

3. To best understand the passage, we need to establish the style employed by the writer. Identify the different tools of style employed in the passage and explain their relevance.

SECTION B

Either

Item 2
You are a member of a drama group that has decided to stage one of the plays that you have studied on the syllabus. During early rehearsals, one of your colleagues suggests that you change the play's setting in order to make it more exciting to the audience. She argues that the setting of any play can be changed without necessarily affecting the play. You strongly disagree because you are aware of the importance of setting, as far as the development of any drama is concerned.

Closely referring to any of the set plays that you have studied, explain the importance of setting in drama.

Or
Item 3

You are attending a Literature seminar and are engaged in a discussion about the relevance of drama to the contemporary society. One of the students feels that most of the texts on the syllabus are outdated and no longer meaningful to the current generation and should therefore be removed from the syllabus. You wish to educate this person and enable them appreciate the fact that literature remains relevant. Despite the change in time and place.

Use one of the drama texts that you have studied on the syllabus to demonstrate the fact that literature is a mirror of the society that we live in.

Either

Item 4
In Literature, characters often find themselves in different life situations, which prompt them to make certain decisions and act in certain ways. In the process, their actions and decisions have an impact on the piece of drama in general.

Refer to one of the novels or short stories that you have studied on the syllabus and explain the role played by one of the prominent characters in developing the story.

In literature, characters often make choice that lead to success, failure or change. Through the experiences that characters go through, writers often teach readers important lessons about life, society or human nature.

Choose one of the novels or short stories that you have studied on the syllabus and explain the lessons that you learn from it.

END.